

art exhibition Mystical Journey

MUMBAI Curiously interwoven into lives and the creative faculties, the recent works by Sujata Bajaj are a reflection of the artist's mind on an imaginative journey. Returning to India from Paris after three years, Bajaj's solo show comes with a book by Jean Claud Carriere that traces five years of her work. Her exhibition showcases a suite of canvases and mixed media works and titles like *Joie de vivre*, *Serenity*, *Enigma* and *Puissance*, exhibit her gravitation towards positive emotions.

Evolving her own style of abstraction and exuberance, every colour on Bajaj's canvas seems to have a reason for existence and a role to fulfil. Her



MIXED CANVAS: Bajaj's works are a play of colours

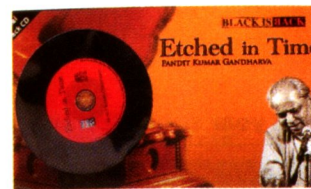
ebony black strokes orchestrate the play of colours by restraining and releasing them simultaneously. "The litany of colours creates a tremendous energy that characterises Sujata's

works," says Kalpana Shah, the director and curator of Tao Art Gallery.

A distinctly different element in Bajaj's work is a blend of archaic Indian calligraphy which she seamlessly weaves in with the depiction of the five elements that create the universe. While she has experimented with etchings, woodcuts, cold ceramics, fibre-glass, metal and mixed media, Bajaj has naturally moved towards acrylic, her most favoured medium. Her latest collection incorporates the textures and sensibilities of printmaking techniques. The mix of colours and shapes, the play of creation, destruction and preservation, the peace and violence are the defining aspects of her work. On view till November 27.

by Swati Mathur

music review Back in Black



Music Today Rs 295

ETCHED IN TIME

They say legends are forever because their contribution is priceless and their art timeless. Listen to a Hindustani classical music compendium that celebrates the valuable contribution of unsurpassable musicians of the golden era packaged in old-world LP record style.

This eight-album series titled *Etched In Time* features unforgettable legends such as Ustad Vilayat Khan (sitar), Pandit Kumar Gandharva (vocal), Begum Akhtar, Pandit C.R. Vyas (vocal), Ustad Bismillah Khan (shehnai), Pandit Mallikarjun Mansoor (vocal) and Shobha Gurtu (vocal) along with one of the most respected and revered classical vocalists of India, Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan.

Each CD is packaged to look like the old black long playing records of yore that were the only form of recorded music. Included in the series are Akhtar's evergreen thumri and ghazals such as *Ab ke sawan*, *Chha rahi kaali ghata*, *Koyaliya mat kar pukar* and *Nanadiya kahe mare*. Also included are Gandharva's best sung ragas such as Raga Hamir, Raga Bhimpalasi and Raga Shree. The series also includes Mansoor's Raga Ramdasi Malhar, Raga Nand and the rare Raga Adambari Kedar and Bismillah Khan's best tracks—Raga Shivanranjani, Bhatiyali and Raga Bhairav. A must for those who love the classics.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

recommendations Turning Point

KOLKATA As artists, there is probably nothing common between Sekhar Roy, 50, and Niranjan Pradhan, 67, except for the fact that both



are from the Government College of Arts, Kolkata. But now, the two artists share neighbouring space in Aakriti, the first holding a solo show in the sculpture wing and the other, in the art wing. Curator Pranabranjan Ray describes the show by

saying that these paintings should be regarded as "a turning point in Roy's outlook on relations between the artist's painted alter-ego and the social situation in which he finds himself."

Pradhan's preoccupation with all things natural comes across with his carved marble faces and shapes. It is, however, his

bronze figurines that amaze the viewer. Expressive faces, and even some modern and funny shapes, like that of a gossiping couple, bring out the artist's perception of the world he lives in. The two shows together make it worth a visit. Till November 14.

by Swagata Sen

BANGALORE FilmCamp.TV's 1:1 filmmaking workshop on November 25 at Lalbagh Gardens from 8.30 a.m. to 7.30 p.m. is a one-day workshop where you can write, storyboard, shoot and edit a one-minute movie in just one day. Entry is limited to 25 participants only with a registration fee of Rs 1,000. The films will be showcased on FilmCamp.TV where they can be viewed by anyone.